



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Canterbury Classical School

School Website: <https://www.canterburyclassicalschool.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Canterbury Classical School NC 28806 presents a coherent classical Christian program with strong evidence of formation-oriented aims, classical curriculum, and active parental/community engagement. Public materials consistently emphasize truth, beauty, and goodness, formation of virtue, and a Trivium-based framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric) alongside Great Books, Latin, and Greek. The school demonstrates explicit religious foundations (Christ-centered, liturgical culture) and a strong partnership with parents, aligning with classical education norms. The Pedagogy category shows several classical elements but does not always state explicit engagement in Socratic/dialogic or scholé practices on the site, resulting in a Somewhat Classical rating for that category. Overall, the school is CLASSICAL.

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Strong CLASSICAL indicators (Christian framing, liturgical culture, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty). Evidence: Christ-centered, liturgical community, and explicit formation aims.
- Purpose and Goal: Formation-focused, virtue-centered, and oriented toward the true/good/beautiful. CLASSICAL.
- Curriculum: Trivium core, Great Books, Latin/Greek, and classical history emphasis. CLASSICAL.
- Pedagogy: Classical approach is evident, but explicit statements about Socratic/Scholé methods are not always present on the site (Somewhat Classical).
- Faculty: Described in terms of formal roles (Head of School, Principals) and a culture of mentors and living curriculum implied by the classical, teacher-centered framing. CLASSICAL.
- Parents & Community: Strong partnership with parents, open to visits, parental formation, and shared culture. CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence: explicit Christian framing, liturgical culture, and formation-focused language (truth/goodness/beauty). Keywords: Christ-centered, liturgical, Christian education, awe/wonder, virtue formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Strong presence of Positive religious/metaphysical terms (Christ-centered, theology implied, liturgy, virtue, truth/goodness/beauty). No evident Negative signals in public materials. This aligns with CLASSICAL. See lexicon mappings for Sainly virtues, liturgy, and transcendental realism.

Why this rating: The school foregrounds a transcendent ordering (truth, goodness, beauty) within a Christian framework and liturgical/community life.

- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence: formation-focused aims, moral and intellectual cultivation, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive terms include formation, virtue, wisdom, great conversation, telos, liberal education. No explicit workforce-preparation rhetoric appears in public materials. This yields CLASSICAL.

Why this rating: Emphasis on formation, virtue, and the perennial aims of education beyond mere information.

- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence: The Trivium is central (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books and classical authors are featured; Latin and Greek instruction; study of classical history.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Seven Liberal Arts (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books, Latin, Greek, history, classical languages, and the Great Conversation. Negative signals (from the provided lexicon) like “social studies terminology replacing history” or “project-based learning dominance” do not appear in the school’s public materials. This category is CLASSICAL.

Why this rating: Curriculum aligns with classical liberal arts, Great Books, and language study.

- Element 4: Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: Public materials emphasize Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books, and formation; explicit references to Socratic discussion or Scholé are not consistently stated on the site. Some classical pedagogy is evident, but missing explicit, trackable statements of Socratic seminars, frequent chanting/narration, or Scholé days in public pages.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include Trivium, Great Books, and classical pedagogy; lack of explicit mentions of Socratic seminars, narration, or Scholé in site copy suggests a partial alignment with Pedagogy keywords. The absence of explicit “Socratic dialogue” or “Scholé” signals means this category does not fully meet the Pedagogy criteria, yielding SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. See lexicon: Socratic dialogue, narration/recitation, and Scholé are core Pedagogy signals.

Why this rating: The school uses classical curriculum and aims, but public-facing pedagogy details (explicit Socratic dialogue, restfulness, and memory-based methods) are not consistently documented on the site.

- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: Exhibits a formal faculty structure (Head of School, Logic & Rhetoric Principal, Grammar School Principal) and a clear “faculty/core” emphasis in materials. Examples include faculty listings and named roles, with a sense of a lived culture (though not all terms like “living curriculum” are explicit in every page).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, and collegiality (as suggested by the site’s structure and leadership). Negative signals such as “facilitators” or “certification-driven jargon without classical context” do not appear. The public materials support CLASSICAL.

Why this rating: Visible leadership roles and a culture that positions teachers as central, knowledgeable guides aligns with the Classical Faculty ideal.

- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: The site emphasizes partnership with parents, parental formation, and open-campus/visitation culture. There are explicit statements about co-teaching with parents and parent engagement in school life.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation, open campus, and family involvement. Negative signals (consumer language, minimal involvement) are not evident in the public materials. This yields CLASSICAL.

Why this rating: Strong parental involvement and community partnership align with classical education norms.

Aggregate Assessment: CLASSICAL

- The school presents strong CLASSICAL alignment in Religion/Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose/-Goal, Curriculum, Faculty, and Parents/Community, with Pedagogy representing a robust classical base but not always stated explicitly in the site copy (hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Element 4). Taken together, Canterbury Classical School NC 28806 is CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Pedagogy (Element 4): Add explicit, public articulation of Scholé/restful learning and memory-based practices (e.g., singing/chanting, narration, and regular Socratic seminars) on the website and in admissions materials. This would elevate Pedagogy from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL by aligning stated practices with classical pedagogical signals in the lexicon.

- For additional clarity, publish a short, formal statement of the school's approach to Socratic dialogue (e.g., Harkness-style discussions) and outline a concrete scaffold from Grammar to Logic to Rhetoric across grade bands, including sample curricula and assessment alignments.
- Consider highlighting concrete examples of Great Books in the curriculum (specific titles), explicit Great Conversation rituals, and examples of student-led seminars to strengthen the category's public evidence.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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